

## Appeal Decision: Appeal Allowed

*Appeal decision · dated 2026-06-12*

- 1.** The appeal is allowed and planning permission is granted for the change of use and extension of the former Old Infirmary to provide 40 retirement apartments (Class C3) with communal facilities, subject to conditions.
- 2.** Main issues: (1) the effect on the character of the Conservation Area; (2) the adequacy of parking. The Inspector found that the removal of the 1970s extension would enhance the Conservation Area and that the scheme would cause less than substantial harm, outweighed by the public benefits including the re-use of a vacant building and the delivery of specialist housing for older people (paras 14 to 19).
- 3.** Parking: the Inspector accepted a provision of 0.5 spaces per unit given the retirement occupancy restriction (para 24).
- 4.** Costs: an application for costs by the appellant was refused. Conditions include a restriction to occupants aged 60 or over (condition 5).